

HTC Sensation XL

Read an in-depth review of this interesting HTC Android smartphone here: http://digit.in/apr_HTCxl

**Karbonn SmartTab 1**

Karbonn Mobiles has announced it will be launching a 7-inch Android 4.0.3 ICS budget tablet in the Indian market soon

HTC Sensation XL

Competent phone let down by the price tag

It's a big phone, and quite clearly feels that way. HTC has smartly thinned the bezel on the right and left side of the display, to shave off precious mm. While it is plastic all through, the build quality is just okay. It doesn't have the premium feel that the black and red finish of the slightly smaller Sensation XE offered.

A single core 1.5GHz Scorpion processor with 768MB RAM powers the Sensation XL. What you should expect is basic performance. Despite having multiple apps open in the background, the phone doesn't slow down. However, when you compare the benchmark scores head to head with the Galaxy Note, the Sensation XL takes a beating.

Reason: the inferior powertrain.

In the HTC Sense 3.5 lock screen, you have four customisable app shortcuts, and dragging the icon into the semi-circle ring takes you directly to that app. The 4.7-inch Super LCD display is one of the best around.

While it isn't as vivid as the Super AMOLED family, the colour depth is still good. The crispness of the text helps quite a bit when reading mail or articles in the web browser.



With an hour of calling, 3G or Wi-Fi connected throughout and Facebook, Twitter, Mails and Whatsapp running, the XL's battery lasted a day. If you're a heavy user, we suggest carrying the charger with you.

We think the price tag of the XL is a bit too steep. For the same amount of money, you get the more powerful Samsung Galaxy Note. Or even consider Motorola Razr, Samsung Galaxy S2 and Sensation XE.

Visbal Mathur

Specifications

Platform: Android 2.3;
Processor: Scorpion 1.5GHz single core; **RAM:** 768MB;
Storage: 16GB, no memory card slot; **Camera:** 8MP with 720p video; **Battery:** 1600 mAh

Contact

HTC India
Email: www.htc.com
Price: ₹37,899

6.0
10

Features 6.0
Performance 7.0
Build Quality 7.0
Value for Money 5.0

Samsung Series 5 NP530U3BI

This is what laptops were supposed to be

Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i5-2467M @ 1.6GHz; **RAM:** 6GB; **Display:** 14-inches, 1366x768 pixels; **Storage:** 1TB HDD; **Graphics:** AMD Radeon HD 7550M (1GB); **Optical drive:** Yes; **OS:** Windows 7 Home Premium (64-bit)

Contact

Samsung India
Phone: +91 22 3030 8282
Price: ₹54,390

7.0
10

Features 7.5
Performance 7.0
Build Quality 7.0
Value for Money 7.5

Despite a tapered design towards one end, the Series 5 doesn't come across as a normal ultrabook. However, it looks extremely classy. The grey matte aluminum finish doesn't catch fingerprints, dust and scratches like glossy surfaces do. The build quality is solid and materials used are better than what we expected.

It houses a 1.6GHz Intel Core i5-2467M paired with 6GB RAM. The performance is quite good, and the laptop doesn't slow down while multitasking. The 14-inch display has a resolution of 1366x768 pixels. Samsung

deserves a pat on the back for ensuring that it's non-reflective.

The keyboard is on a slightly depressed platform. Key size is bigger than what we see in the Macbook, and with adequate palm rest real estate. However, the key press extracts a very muffled (soft, if you may) sound, a contrast to

the MacBook's chunky sound. A big touchpad means multi-touch gestures will be comfortable to use.

The battery lasts about three hours in our standard-battery test. Under standard daily usage, it will last you a bit more than 4.5 hours easily.

The 1TB hard drive is something that can't be overlooked, and neither can the USB 3.0 ports, integrated optical drive and a very comfortable display and keyboard. Dedicated graphics means this one will do a bit of gaming as well.

For this price, what you'll get is essentially a mid-range laptop that has focused more on being slim and portable.

Visbal Mathur

